

TELCONG NETPLAN

Network Planning & Regulatory Affairs

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Community Engagement Playbook

Operational playbook for site acquisition community engagement

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Linked confluence	pg_community_engagement_playbook

1. Principles

Community engagement for new cell sites in Nasarawa State follows four principles: (1) the traditional authority is the recognised gatekeeper for community land and must be consulted before the first site visit; (2) the community council is the collective voice and must be engaged via public briefing before site preparation begins; (3) objections are documented and resolved on the record, not ignored or worked around; (4) commitments made to the community are kept and audited.

2. Pre-engagement preparation

Before the first site visit, the field team prepares: (a) a one-page site briefing document in plain English (and Hausa for non-English-speaking communities); (b) a draft letter to the traditional authority requesting an audience; (c) a list of likely community concerns based on the site location and recent community council records; (d) a draft community benefit proposal where appropriate. The briefing pack is approved by Chioma Ndukwe before any external communication.

3. Traditional authority engagement

The traditional authority engagement is the first formal step. The field lead requests an audience via formal letter, copied to the relevant LGA Community Affairs Officer. The audience takes place at the traditional authority's place of residence or council chambers, not at the operator's office or a neutral venue. Attendees: traditional authority, field lead (Ifeyanyi Okeke or designate), Community Engagement Coordinator (Chioma Ndukwe), and any community elders the traditional authority chooses to include. The Coordinator documents the meeting and provides a written record to the traditional authority within 48 hours.

4. Community town hall briefing

Following the traditional authority audience and with their consent, a public town hall briefing is held for residents within 300 metres of the proposed site. The briefing covers: the proposed site location, the equipment to be installed, the EMF safety considerations in plain language, the construction timeline, the lease arrangement (without revealing commercial terms), the community benefit proposal, and the contact details for community feedback. Refreshments customary to the community shall be provided.

5. Objection handling

Objections to a proposed site are documented in the standard objection register format and responded to within 14 calendar days via the standard reply template (objection_letter_template - linked separately). Each objection has a named owner; the owner is responsible for the resolution conversation with the objecting party. Resolution may include: (a) site relocation within the ward; (b) modified equipment configuration; (c) community benefit adjustment; (d) withdrawal of the proposal if resolution is not possible. Withdrawal is the last resort but is sometimes the right outcome.

6. Consent recording

Community consent is recorded in writing, signed by the traditional authority and witnessed by at least two community council members. Consent records are filed in the airtable records_nasarawa_sites table (Community_Engagement_Status column transitions to 'concluded' upon receipt of signed consent) and the physical document is filed at the TelcoNG NetPlan office in Wuse II.

7. Five active Phase 1 objection threads

As of the date of this playbook update, Phase 1 has 5 active objection threads, at sites NSW-PHASE1-S03 (Lafia / Akun, Chief Musa Adamu), NSW-PHASE1-S08 (Akwanga / Andaha, Mrs. Patience Yakubu), NSW-PHASE1-S11 (Karu / Mararaba, Pastor Daniel Ogbu), NSW-PHASE1-S14 (Keffi / Angwa, Alhaji Sadiq Ibrahim), and NSW-PHASE1-S15 (Nasarawa / Toto, Chief Patrick Audu). Each thread has a named owner and a resolution timeline tracked on the monday board.

8. Escalation

Where an objection cannot be resolved at the field-team and Coordinator level within 60 days, the matter escalates to the Director of Network Operations (Eng. Babatunde Olatunji) and the Senior Network Planning Engineer (Sheila Stokes) for a strategic decision on site retention or withdrawal.